

one market and sells in another. He has simple ideas on how to make money, like "buy low, sell high."

"If I'm in New York and see an undervalued painting, I'll buy it. It may sell better in Paris than in New York. The next time I go to Paris I'll take the paintings and sell them. I may go to Paris in six months or in six years. So I need pretty good margins when I sell."

Does he make enough money to live?

"My apartment is paid for," he told me. "To buy it I sold a Picasso painting I had picked up in Paris when I was a kid. My car is a piece of junk. My only expenses are food, the maids, clothing, school supplies for the kids, and incidentals. I figure I spend \$1,800 a month, a little over \$20,000 a year. I can make that much by selling just one painting."

Is Nick retired? Since he never set out to work in an organized way, the idea of breaking the work habit never came up. He has no office, secretary, stationery, or any of the trappings of the modern businessman. Whether he does a deal in a given week, month, or year means nothing. With his low expenses—just over \$50 a day—he feels little pressure to make deals happen.

Nick's father inherited the family business and sold it at age 34. Dad lived on the income for the rest of his life. Perhaps it's Dad's influence, but Nick thinks not working is more natural than working. "I can't understand why so-called liberated women want to bash their way into the executive suite. Working at the office all day is the most unliberating thing anyone can do. To lead a rich, fulfilling life you need to free yourself from the job, not enslave yourself to it."

When he's at home in Marbella, Nick gets up at about 11:00 A.M. to answer the phone. The caller is likely to get invited to lunch or dinner. Nick then pulls on a pair of swimming trunks and heads to the beach, writes a letter to a friend from college works up an article on a current art exhibit for an English-language newspaper, or runs personal errands. At about 2:00 P.M. he returns home for lunch, a